example, has decided that for the first six overs of a 20-over game, we should rather go for consistency than hitting balls over the top. Do you think Aussie opening pair David Warner and Shane Watson have been given that instruction? If they have, they've clearly been doing their level best to ignore it.

Not with us, though, and it's why we never got runs in the games against New Zealand and England. Graeme and Jacques hardly came off, and then it was like, 'Okay, Hersch, now you go out there and play your natural game.' There are too many of the same ideas, no flexibility and no ability to quickly switch to another game plan if the current one isn't working.

At the toss before the final group game against Pakistan, which we had to win to stay in the tournament, commentator and former Pakistani batsman Rameez Raja asked Graeme what it was like to prepare against a team as unpredictable as Pakistan. Graeme's response was, well, it wasn't too difficult, because we were pretty unpredictable ourselves. I wondered about this. I'm not sure 'unpredictable' is the word I would've used. Inconsistent? Yes. Unpredictable? Not exactly. All this talk of being more instinctive and expressive … ja … I've yet to see it.

As I said, Warner and Watson are going hell for leather from ball one – just like Adam Gilchrist and Matthew Hayden did for them in the 50-over game. If they failed, they failed quickly, but if they came off, they got 60 or 70 runs in no time. That's the basis of success in one-day cricket since Sanath Jayasuriya and Romesh Kaluwitharana paved the way in the 1996 World Cup.

The game is becoming more and more attacking each season – particularly on the subcontinent. If you don't have guys who fire upfront there, you leave yourself with far too much to do – especially with our less-than-stellar history against spin-bowling. I reckon the Proteas would really benefit by opening the innings with a Warner or Watson-like batsman who possesses the kind of explosive power and improvisational skills to win you a game upfront.

I think the selectors have tried this route, picking Loots Bosman as a 20-over opener in the 2010 T20 World Cup and the T20 series against the West Indies that followed. Unfortunately for Loots, he wasn't very successful. You've got to feel for the guy in this situation. No doubt, Loots has all those explosive shots in his armoury – his domestic record certainly proves that – but his ability to express himself was clearly hampered by injury. He'd just